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## Easy Come, Easy Go

The first rule of becoming wealthy is not to lose money. The second rule is not to forget the first rule.

—Warren Buffet

Many people who receive large sums of money all at once end up losing it within a short period of time. This scenario has been repeated many times over the years by people who have received inheritances, won the lottery, signed a huge sports contract, or had a hit in the entertainment business. For many people, the tendency is to see a windfall as unlimited. You think you couldn't possibly spend it all. Now is the opportunity to buy that new car to replace the old, to move into a one-bedroom apartment and out of that cramped studio, to get a whole new wardrobe, or to visit those exotic places you've always dreamed of.

Oftentimes a sudden influx of money causes confusion to people who are unaccustomed to dealing with such large amounts. For example, the same story often repeats itself for celebrities who have new-found wealth and can't cope with their riches. We read of their now chaotic lives that contrast strongly with their grounded and focused lives before their wealth.

What people do not tend to realize is that even large sums of money can go rather quickly if one lives extravagantly.